

Linping Zhang

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MSc Banking and Digital Finance candidate at UCL with sell-side equity research experience and hands-on work in fundamental analysis, valuation and data-driven investment research.

EDUCATION

MSc Banking and Digital Finance — University College London (UCL) Sep 2025 – Sep 2026 (expected)
BSc Finance — Nanjing Agricultural University (NAU) Sep 2021 – Jun 2025
GPA: 90.42/100 (3.85/4.5) — Top 13% of cohort

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Equity Research Assistant — Huachuang Securities — Consumer/Liquor Sector Sep 2024 – Jan 2025

- Independently analysed the fundamentals, market positioning and ownership structure of six listed companies within ongoing coverage of 13 firms; researched spirits markets across the US, Europe and Asia using PEST analysis, contributing to two industry reports.
- Monitored company, sales and regulatory developments and maintained industry datasets, producing five market-tracking reports and synthesising 16 research studies (~80,000 words) into analyst-ready research inputs.

Audit Intern — KPMG — Audit Department Jan 2025

- Cross-checked audit-report figures against supporting financial data and conducted sample testing across two client engagements, reviewing ledgers, contracts, invoices and bank receipts for accuracy and completeness of evidence.

Finance & Audit Assistant — Shandong Qirun Accounting Firm Jan 2024 – Feb 2024

- Reviewed accounting vouchers and prepared ledgers and financial statements for 10 SME clients, supporting tax reconciliation and audit procedures under reporting deadlines.

INVESTMENT RESEARCH & VALUATION PROJECTS — UCL

AI-Driven Equity Research Agent — NVIDIA — Individual project — full build | *Intro to Financial Markets*

- Independently built an equity-research framework for NVIDIA combining 12+ fundamental metrics with DCF and comparable-company valuation against five semiconductor peers; weighted DCF (40%) and multiples (60%) to reflect NVIDIA's growth profile and relative valuation characteristics.
- Derived DCF assumptions from Treasury yields, beta and real-GDP growth, and performed sensitivity analysis across discount-rate and terminal-growth scenarios, benchmarking implied value against comparable-company estimates.

Equity Valuation & Investment Recommendation — Hindustan Unilever — Group project — independent DCF ownership | *Corporate Finance & Asset Pricing*

- Independently built a complete DCF model using historical FCF, five-year forecasts and terminal-value assumptions to derive enterprise value and implied equity value per share against the ₹2,300 market price.
- Reviewed and validated the data underlying the team's DDM and comparable-company valuations, authored the qualitative analysis and valuation-limitations sections, and co-authored the final Hold recommendation integrating all three valuation methods.

LSTM-Based Equity Trading Strategy Evaluation — Independent project — full ownership | *Financial Analytics & ML*

- Independently replicated and evaluated a published LSTM equity strategy across multiple market regimes and realistic transaction costs; found post-publication performance deteriorated materially, showing that statistical predictability did not necessarily translate into sustainable investable returns.

SKILLS & ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Investment & Valuation: Fundamental Analysis, Equity Research, DCF, DDM, Comparable Companies, Financial Statement Analysis, Sensitivity Analysis

Tools: Excel, Bloomberg Terminal (basic), Wind, Choice Data

Programming: Python (pandas, scikit-learn; project-based), SQL (basic)

Languages: Mandarin (Native), English (Professional working proficiency)

Awards & Leadership: Merit Student Scholarship; 3rd Prize, 10th ERP Sand Table Simulation Competition (Team Leader); Deputy Minister, Elite Accountants Association (NAU).